

SUCCESS SNAPS



INTALKWITH

ALOK BHARADWAJ
SENIOR VICE PRESIDENT
CANON INDIA

- Please provide us an insight into the development of the company since its inception?

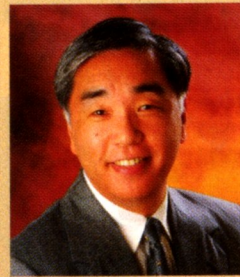
Canon India Pvt. Ltd. was incorporated in 1997. Eight years out of these 12 years were the formative years when Canon was getting into different areas of business. But the last four years have marked a very high growth rate for Canon. The growth rate having touched 30 per cent mark. It is partly because of the high growth rate of the economy as driving force behind any company's success and partly because we grew faster than the industry. Therefore, we have accumulated a distinguished share in the market and also in almost all categories of businesses that we are in.

- What initiatives were taken to sustain the increased growth rate of Canon India?

We have consistently followed the path of launching about 100 new products every year. The whole process requires rapid transformation. Therefore, we launch new technologies to give the customers functionalities which are both – relevant and differentiated.

Secondly, we invest heavily into capacity building. Canon is into the businesses related to digital imaging – digital camera, photo printers, video camcorders, digital SLR, inkjet printers, laser printers, scanners, documents high-speed scanners, digital copiers, projectors, multi-functional faxes and large digital colour presses. More or less everything's to do with digital imaging. Being a formidable player with over 140 products in consumer and business segment and 100 more to be launched every year, we need a platform to showcase our state-of-the-art technology products. So, we invested Rs 20 crores in six demo centres 2 each in –

OWING TO ITS CUTTING-EDGE TECHNOLOGY AND WORLD-CLASS PRODUCTS, CANON REGISTERS A WHOPPING GROWTH OF OVER 30 PER CENT



KENSAKU KONISHI
President and CEO
Canon India

We are very happy with our growth in India and at the same time delighted to act as a bridge for promoting culture and business relations between India and Japan.

Mumbai, Gurgaon and Bangalore. One is consumer image lounge and other is Business Solution Lounge. In a growing economy like ours, it is imperative for companies to continue to deploy new technologies aimed at creating a more productive work environment. Consumer showrooms are called Canon Image Lounge. Now, we have about 100 products in Image Lounge and about 41 products in Business Solution Lounge. And this investment positioned Canon products and technologies in a very strong fashion.

- How is the Indian market different and what challenges are faced by the brand in India?

Strategically, Indian market is of high importance for Canon. India is relatively a high growth economy; second largest after China. This has been a year of downturn so far but still in India we have registered a growth rate of 20 per cent in the first six months of the calendar year. We are expecting it to close at 25 per cent by the end of 2009. The challenge is that Indian consumer is value conscious and considers price carefully.

- What were the payoffs last year and what is expected this year?

Last year our revenue was Rs 665 crore, and our growth rate was 31 per cent. This year we are expecting to be a Rs 840 crore company and we are looking at a Rs 1,000 crore turnover next year.

- What are the forthcoming technologies?

Despite the slowdown, Canon continually focused on its R&D. We have come up with unheard-of technologies in digital cameras. The still cameras have high-definition video quality and they have become more intelligent. In fact, we call it intuitive technology. These cameras work like human mind.

The other impressive launch is a shock-proof, water-proof and dust-resistant camera especially created for off-the-road photography.

On the business side, we have launched a new document business solution which will help us in shifting our footing from top selling company to a wholesome solution provider.

- Can you provide us an insight into the success of the company since its inception in India?

At early stage of booming economic growth, Komatsu focuses their attention on Indian mining business with high future growth potential. Komatsu has constructed a factory where producing mining dump truck as leading product and provides Indian customers with world leading-edge trucks. Komatsu assigned Japanese design engineers to this factory. On top of that, Japanese and Indian service engineers are assigned to the place where customers are expected to be around. Komatsu appointed the most well-known engineering Indian company, Larsen & Toubro as their partner to provide world top class product support service to their customers.

- What are the latest technologies that Komatsu is offering to India market?

All of Komatsu mining machines are equipped with Vehicle Health Monitoring System (VHMS) developed by them as standard equipment; it reduces machine

operation cost for Indian customers, who demand very high level of cost efficiency. In particular, analyzed data from VHMS offers customers to have systematic machine maintenance and preventive measures against unexpected failures. Eventually, it enables customers to achieve highest productivities and efficiency in fuel consumption and overall operation.

As to fleet machine, Komatsu applies their Optimum Fleet Recommendation System (OFR) to offer the most suitable fleet of their machines. Komatsu provides their technical know-how compiled from their experience in the mining developed countries with Indian customers.

- What initiatives company has taken to sustain the growth rate in challenging time like this?

Whatever the circumstances, Komatsu believes it is important to be loyal to the fundamental principles; to provide leading-edge technology equipped machine and service/support to maintain high operation rates. It is unavoidable to face reduced number of machines due to economic fluctuation; however, Komatsu secures the current customers by being loyal to the basic policy.

- What is your say on the growing Indo-Japan trade partnership?

If Free Trade Agreement or Economic Partnership Agreement between India and Japan is made and fulfilled for the mutual benefit, Komatsu believes it will help to expand their trade and business. They can offer their state-of-art products/service at much reasonable cost and it will contribute to the highest productivities for Indian customers.

Source : As shared by the spokesperson of the company

